

We agree with BAAPS—aside from the medical complications, we can't begin to imagine the complications that could arise from a loony donor getting unrestricted access to someone's profile and all their personal details. The site allows donors to "purchase any personal products the ladies may have for sale" and even "receive custom photos of your favourite girls (you may even request specific outfits)," which makes the process even scarier.

Still, from what we know of America, young women there save up for boob-jobs as though it were a routine procedure. So strictly speaking, men sponsoring the thing shouldn't create too much hubbub. What's interesting is that it's happening on the Net—sign of the times, we say.

MECHA-MARRIAGE

Best Bot

A robot recently presided over the marriage ceremony of a couple

Obituary: Mayur Bhatia

Nothing shocks one quite as much as the passing of someone right in the midst of one's group. The death of Mayur—due to an internal organ dysfunction—has shaken us not only because it was so unexpected, but also because he was such an extremely gentle, soft-spoken, shy, lovable little guy.

Mayur was the youngest amongst us. When he joined our team, he seemed a misfit because he'd speak only when spoken to—and we mostly spoke to him about work. What a surprise, then, that we found he was a gamer—an avid one who could kick anyone's butt at *Quake 3*. In general, he'd be engrossed in his work to an extent that people had to physically shake him by the shoulder to get his attention! Ultra-focused,

lost, and technologically very knowledgeable describe him best.

Yes, he was exceptionally knowledgeable—specifically about system tweaking, networking, and, of course, gaming. His after-hours were generally spent on the Sify LAN in Thane (near Mumbai); he was well-known in the gaming circles there.

Always eager to try his hand at new things, be it a feature article or a game review or a product review, he was quite the ideal worker—perhaps a little *too* ideal. We now wish we could have gotten to know him better, that he could have opened up a bit, felt a little less stiff while around us...

We can only take our comfort in the idea that God takes young those He loves the most. Rest in peace, Mayur.

DIGIT DIARY

in South Korea. Believe it.

The bridegroom, Seok Gyeong-Jae, is one of the engineers who designed the robot for Hanool Robotics. The firm brags that after its marital duties were completed, the robot was "upgraded" to perform other duties. Details of these "other duties" are sketchy, but we can only imagine that the bot must have been busy socialising with guests at the drinks table or setting

the dance floor afire with a partner.

If you don't need Tiro (the robot in question) administering your nuptials, he is also available for hire as a robot Master of Ceremonies (MC), complete with "sweet female voice," for rent at a mere \$215,000 (Rs 88 lakh).

Now, we definitely didn't see this coming, but just so things like this don't surprise us in the future,

let's predict where we might see robots. Delivering a sermon... what kind of God would they speak about? A funeral service... what kind of death would they refer to... dead batteries? How about news anchors...? That one's a possibility—only, they'd sort of look funny in those formal outfits.

Actually, let's leave it to the Koreans and the Japanese to figure all such things out. ☒

Blog WATCH

The iPhone, Safari for Windows, Leopard. Predictable topics, interesting posts.

Paul Stamatiou

<http://tinyurl.com/27nhst>

iPhone on 29th June, But Not for ME

Yesterday,... Geoff Ramsey, CEO of eMarketer's funniest remark was when he told us that the "Fear of Google" was so prevalent that it even had a three-letter acronym: FOG. Anyway, I've been hearing more and more about FOG all weekend... Here's a few examples:

Why did the stock market drive shares of Yahoo! up so fast on total rumors that Microsoft was buying Yahoo!? Easy, we wanted it to happen. "We" being journalists who are living in FOG land. Bloggers who'd like to see Microsoft be interesting again... Several people on the boat were hoping that Microsoft would buy Yahoo! simply to keep competition going in the advertising market...

Matt Mondok

<http://tinyurl.com/yro8ac>

Microsoft, Mozilla execs respond to Safari on Windows announcement

For companies like Microsoft and Mozilla, Safari coming to Windows means that one more competitor will be thrown into the Windows browser battlefield. While neither company has expressed dismay with Apple's decision to put

Safari on Windows, on Monday executives from both Microsoft and Mozilla expressed a lack of concern for their new (Windows) foe.

Mozilla vice president of engineering, Mike Schroepfer, said that he'd like to see Apple push open standards for the web.

"We are excited to see the resurgence of interest in browsers. We encourage Apple to put their weight behind open standards and the open Web to help ensure all browser users, regardless of operating system or browser, can enjoy the best possible Web experience."

David Chartier

<http://tinyurl.com/36jdjm>

Leopard's new menu bar is hideous

I've been spending (time) looking through the other new features of Leopard. After I found that non-transparent menubar mod, however, I can't get over how hideous that new menubar really is. I also hate to say it, but Apple's secrecy with this UI change until now screams 'Cupertino borrowed one of Redmond's photocopyers' (the new Windows Vista, for those who haven't seen it, contains what many—including myself—consider to be a literally dizzying overabundance of transparent window borders and menus).